THE COOLEST ONES

Beat both the heat and humidity with this new generation of air conditioners that does more than lower the temperature

By RIDHI KALE

Perfect Chill Pill

If you think the Indian summer is a formidable opponent, meet the Acerpure Chill Neo, the heavyweight champion of cool. This 1.5-ton powerhouse doesn't just fight the heat; it annihilates it, even when the outdoors feels like a literal furnace at 58°C. Designed for the modern medium-sized room, the Chill Neo is as smart as it is sleek. Its seven-in-one convertible technology allows you to tailor the cooling capacity to your guest list (or your mood), while the Ice Blast Mode acts like a fast-forward button for instant cool. Thanks to the four-way swing, every corner of your room gets equal attention; no more fighting for the sweet spot under the vents. Boasting the New 2026 5-Star BEE Rating, it uses just 699.24 units a year. It's the perfect blend of high-tech chilling and high-efficiency living.

PRICE ₹65,990

Intelligent Options

Move over, smart thermostats, Haier's new Gravity AI Series is the high-IQ tool you never knew you needed. With AI Pre-Cooling, a 100m geofence detects your arrival and cools the room before you even turn the key. Once inside, AI Climate Control 2.0 studies your habits, while AI Target Cooling uses cloud data to point the breeze exactly where you're sitting. Auto Clean Outdoor Technology uses reverse airflow to kick out dust; and AI Frost Self-Clean maintains hygienic every 240 hours.

PRICE ₹49,990 onwards

Blown Away

Samsung's Bespoke AI WindFree Pro, an AC comes with 5 Motion Wind technology. So, whether you need the Max Wind setting to crush a heatwave or Surround Wind for a gentle, even distribution, this machine adapts in real-time. Those who hate the feeling of icy air blowing directly on them, the WindFree Cooling is a game-changer. It disperses air through 23,000 micro-holes, creating a Still Air environment that feels like a natural breeze rather than a mechanical blast. It also syncs with your Galaxy Watch or Galaxy Ring, adjusting the temperature based on your body's data. Plus, with Welcome Cooling & Away Care, it anticipates your arrival, while the AI Energy Mode reduces power consumption.

PRICE ₹66,990